

Why Mobile and Web App Testing is Critical

This article gives a detailed description of mobile and Web app testing. It is a must-read for anyone who wants to make a career in testing.



Mobile testing is basically the testing of an application on a mobile platform. Such applications are developed to run on mobile devices. They are mainly tested for functionality, usability and consistency. Nowadays, mobility solutions have taken over the market. People don't want to switch on their laptops or PCs for everything, but would rather use their handheld devices to perform tasks quickly. Hence the mobile solutions that are delivered to clients should be tested very well.

Some open source tools that can be used for mobile app testing are Appium, Calabash, Money talk, Robotium, etc.

Web app testing

This is basically software testing that focuses on Web applications. It is a software testing technique exclusively adopted to test the applications that are hosted on the Web, to which the application interfaces.

Some open source tools for this are Selenium, JMeter, WebLOAD, Grinder, OpenSTA, etc. Among these, Selenium is the most popular.

The importance of testing a project before delivery

Testing is necessary because nothing is perfect in this world. We all make mistakes, i.e., in the process of software development, bugs often do emerge. We learn from our mistakes and once identified, we iron out the bugs. Some of these mistakes are unimportant, but some can be expensive or dangerous. So to prevent major mishaps, we need to test everything that is delivered to customers.

Some reasons for mobile testing

1. It is important to ensure that the application does

not result in any failures because that can prove very expensive in the future or in the later stages of software development.

- Proper testing ensures that bugs and issues are detected early in the life cycle of the product or application.
 - If defects related to requirements or design are detected late in the life cycle, it can be very expensive to fix them, since this might require redesign, reimplementation and retesting of the application.
2. It is very important to ensure the quality of the product. A quality product delivered to customers helps in gaining their confidence.
 3. Testing is essential since it ensures that the customer finds the organisation reliable and is satisfied with the application.
 4. Testing is necessary to provide customers high quality products or software applications that are low in maintenance and, consequently, result in more accurate, consistent and reliable results. High quality products typically have fewer defects and require lesser maintenance, which means reduced costs.
 5. Last but not the least, testing is required to stay in the business. In the case of a product organisation or a startup which has only one product, the poor quality of software may result in lack of product adoption, which may result in losses that the business may not recover from.

Case study

I will share my personal experience here. We had to deliver an e-commerce project to our client. But we didn't catch one major bug and the project went live. After some hours, somebody from the client side caught the bug and fixed the issue. But the damage had been done by then.